



OREGON YOUTH AUTHORITY

Policy Statement

Part I – Administrative Services



Subject:

Staff Training and Development

Section – Policy Number:

D: Personnel Management – 3.9

Supersedes:

I-D-3.9 (10/23)
I-D-3.9 (06/22)
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I-D-3.9 (6/03)

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06/22/2026

Date of Last Review/Revision:

None

Related Standards and References:

- [DAS policy 50.035.01](#) (Performance Management Process)
- [DAS policy 50.045.01](#) (Employee Development and Implementation of Oregon Benchmarks for Workforce Development)
- American Correctional Association, *Standards for Juvenile Correctional Facilities*; 5-JCF-7E-01 (Staff Development)
- [OYA policy](#): 0-2.1 Professional Standards
I-D-3.8 Agency Training Program
I-E-3.0 OYA External Communications
- [OYA forms](#): YA 1200 Training Roster
YA 2229 Out-of-State Travel Authorization

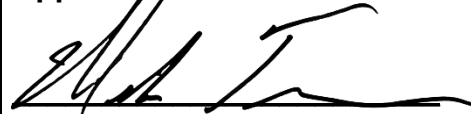
Related Procedures:

- Checklist: Use of Staff Images in OYA Training Events
- TA I-E-3.8 Curriculum Development Workgroups

Policy Owner:

Training Academy Director

Approved:


Mike Tessean, Director

I. PURPOSE:

This policy establishes OYA's standards for staff training lesson plans, training delivery, training attendance approval, trainee and trainer responsibilities, and training documentation.

II. POLICY DEFINITIONS:

Agency training: Training developed and provided by OYA (usually through the Training Academy) for OYA staff.

Curriculum development workgroup: A cross-agency group convened to develop course descriptions, learning outcomes, and evaluation methods for specific training topics.. This group may also include representatives from other agencies and community partners. Membership varies by topic and need, and

must include decision-makers, content experts, and representatives of marginalized communities.

In-Service training: Professional development provided to employees while they are actively working in their roles to strengthen skills, update knowledge, and maintain alignment with agency expectations. It is role-specific, continuous, focused on practical application, and encourages collaboration and shared learning among participants.

Knowledge, Skills, and Abilities (KSAs): A competency framework describing the knowledge an individual must possess, the skills they must be able to perform, and the abilities—both natural and developed—that support effective job performance.

Local training: Training developed and provided by a local facility or office for staff who work at that facility or office.

New Employee Training (NET): A structured, five-week training program for newly hired staff that includes classroom instruction and on-the-job shadowing.

Orientation training: Mandatory introductory training for newly hired staff that provides foundational information about agency policies, expectations, and job requirements. It is delivered through online instruction, classroom learning, one-on-one mentoring, or a combination of these methods.

Qualified OYA instructors: OYA staff who have knowledge and expertise in the subject matter they present, and are skilled in presenting topics to adult learners.

Training: An organized and evaluated learning process designed to build the knowledge, skills, and abilities (KSAs) needed for effective job performance. It uses structured methods, clear objectives, and practical application to ensure participants can understand and apply what they learn, supporting both individual development and organizational goals.

Training Advisory Committee (TAC): An agency committee that assesses agency training needs and aligns training strategies to support and implement agency (and juvenile justice) business initiatives most effectively. Membership must include the Training Academy director and representative decision-makers from all OYA departments, professional trainers, and OYA training end users.

Training Evaluation System: A structured way to understand how well training works by collecting immediate participant feedback, checking how effectively people use what they learned on the job, measuring skill growth and behavior change at three- and six-month intervals, and looking at how all of this contributes to the agency's overall performance and priorities.

Training expenses: Expenses related to a training activity that include, but are not limited to, leave requests, travel, per diem costs, and tuition.

Workday Learning: An Oregon state employee learning management system that retains employee training records and online courses.

Workday Learning partner: An OYA staff member who is trained to enter data into Workday Learning and support Workday Learning at the local level.

III. **POLICY:**

OYA has identified diversity, equity, and inclusion as an agency priority and initiative, with a goal to build a respectful, diverse, equitable and inclusive environment for youth and staff that is free from harassment, discrimination, and bias. While OYA is only one part of a system that has disproportionately impacted youth of color and LGBTQ+ youth, it plays a critical role in addressing the historical and systemic inequities it perpetuates. It is critical that OYA staff are trained and educated on the historically racist foundation of the juvenile justice system, its impact on marginalized groups, and the connection to current issues within juvenile justice. It is also imperative that staff professional development opportunities are equitable, do not perpetuate disparate impacts to marginalized groups, and balance being responsible stewards of state resources. It is also imperative that staff be educated on bias, develop a self-awareness of their own biases and how to prevent bias from impacting decision points within their spheres of influence.

OYA values a productive, motivated, culturally responsive, and culturally diverse workforce. OYA has a coordinated, comprehensive system of staff development and training designed for the following purposes:

- To help meet internal and external mandates by providing the training necessary to execute agency policies and procedures in a consistent and timely manner;
- To provide effective services to youth by ensuring that staff have the basic competencies to carry out their job responsibilities;
- To enhance staff knowledge, skills, abilities, and competencies to perform jobs more efficiently and effectively; and
- To provide staff with opportunities for continued personal and professional development.

The Training Academy coordinates and facilitates the agency's training program to ensure the training needs of OYA offices and facilities are consistently met and in aligned with the agency's mission and values. The Training Academy engages staff early, recognizes learning as an ongoing process, partners with managers and key collaborators, and delivers relevant, real-world, data-informed training grounded in youth perspectives. In addition, the Training Academy partners with managers and divisions to provide a cohesive onboarding experience for new agency staff, ensuring the Academy-led onboarding aligns effectively with facility- and division-level onboarding processes.

The Training Academy ensures all OYA staff training curriculum and lesson plans (LPs) meet recognized professional standards. In addition, the Training Academy develops partnerships with other state agencies, county juvenile departments, correctional and juvenile justice organizations, and colleges to support a consistent and competent continuum of services throughout Oregon.

IV. GENERAL STANDARDS:

- A. The Training Academy must collaborate with supervisors, managers, division leadership, and other key partners to assess both division-wide and local training needs and, as appropriate to business priorities, provide guidance on service delivery options.
- B. All OYA agency training delivered to OYA staff must use an OYA-approved lesson plan or curriculum and be facilitated by qualified OYA instructors.
 - 1. The curriculum development workgroup must review curriculum and lesson plans to ensure alignment with OYA standards and mission, verify instructor qualifications, and, as appropriate to the topic or training need, require revisions or additional guidance.
 - 2. OYA staff training must contain:
 - a) A clear description of the training course;
 - b) Defined learning outcomes;
 - c) A documented lesson plan outlining the content delivered;
 - d) Consideration of potential impacts on marginalized groups;
 - e) Methods for measuring training effectiveness; and
 - f) Documented attendance for all training formats (e.g., live sessions and self-paced learning, whether online, in-person, or on-site).
- C. Training affecting service delivery to youth requires approval from the Training Advisory Committee (TAC) before it is implemented.

Supervisors may send staff to observe such training without the TAC's approval when the intent is to gather information to share with the agency.
- D. Staff training request approvals
 - 1. All training requests, including authorization for training expenses, must be approved by the supervisor before training begins.
 - 2. Requests for out-of-state training must be approved by an assistant director, who will forward the request to the Director's Office for final approval.
- E. Training for other agencies or community partners
 - 1. A staff member who is asked to represent OYA while providing training to other agencies or community partners must have approval from their supervisor prior to acting on the request.

2. For individuals who are not certified trainers in the content they intend to deliver, the supervisor must review and approved the lesson plan or training agenda before authorizing the training. The Training Academy director may be consulted for guidance as needed.

F. Individual staff development

OYA supports staff development to ensure employees are prepared to perform their jobs competently and effectively.

1. Orientation training

All new staff must complete mandatory orientation training within 60 days of their hire date. This training is delivered through online instruction, classroom learning, one-on-one mentoring, or a combination of these methods.

2. New Employee Training (NET)

- a) New staff must complete NET as appropriate to their job duties and classifications within 90 days of their hire dates. This training is delivered through online instruction, classroom learning, one-on-one mentoring, or a combination of these methods.
- b) Any exceptions to NET requirements must be reviewed and approved by the appropriate assistant director, in collaboration with the Human Resources administrator and the Training Academy director, to ensure consistency and support operational needs.

Exceptions must:

- (1) Be documented in writing;
- (2) List the factors considered for the exception;
- (3) Detail an alternate training plan; and
- (4) Be retained by the Training Academy.

3. Annual training and professional development

All OYA staff must complete training annually.

- a) Training topics will include those required by job classification, law, OYA policy, and related bargaining agreements. Requirements related to defensive tactics, physical intervention, and restraint training (including who must complete them, applicable timelines, and renewal expectations) are detailed in OYA policy II-B-1.1 Physical

Intervention in OYA Facilities, section IV.G. Training. These trainings are competency-based.

- b) OYA encourages staff to participate in professional development opportunities identified in their Individual Development Plans. In-service training is one of the available options staff may use to meet their annual training and professional development requirement. Training Academy learning and development specialists are available as a resource to help staff and supervisors learn more about in-service training opportunities, including those typically planned on a quarterly basis each year.
4. Approval for non-mandatory training and staff development activities is a local management decision which must consider:
- a) Local need, including alignment with the staff's development plan and the work unit's training needs;
 - b) Available training funds (including per diem, travel, tuition, and staffing costs);
 - c) The unit/office ability to meet operating requirements while the staff participates in training;
 - d) Training that meets staff need; and
 - e) Fulfilling agency goals, mission.
5. Specific roles
- a) Supervisors
 - (1) Assess and identify staff training and development needs.
 - (2) Facilitate training opportunities that address the development needs of individual staff or the work unit.
 - (3) Schedule staff for mandatory training and adjust workload to support participation. .
 - (4) Approve or deny non-mandatory training and professional development activities based on agency training priorities, budget availability, and workload coverage.
 - (5) Ensure completion and documentation of all required training and professional development activities.
 - b) Staff

- (1) Assess training and development needs related to job duties and developmental goals.
- (2) Collaborate with their supervisors to identify development plans during regularly scheduled performance management meetings.
- (3) Provide documentation of completed professional development activities to their supervisors.
- (4) Attend classroom or online training as approved and scheduled.
- (5) Sign required attendance documentation (e.g., roster).
- (6) Provide recommendations for curriculum development and improvement through the local management structure.

G. Training documentation

1. All training requests must be made in writing by a staff member or supervisor, as appropriate.

2. Workday Learning

OYA must retain a computerized training record for each staff member that documents completed training and staff development activities. These records are retained in the Workday Learning management system.

- a) Agency classroom or in-person training must be documented on OYA form YA 1200 (Training Roster).

- (1) Agency training provided by the Training Academy

A designated Training Academy staff will enter the corresponding training into Workday Learning.

- (2) Agency training provided by the JJIS Business Integration Team.

A designated Information Systems staff will enter the corresponding training into Workday Learning.

- b) Workday Learning partners must enter completed local training into Workday Learning.

- c) Completion of training or professional development activities that do not meet the criteria described in the paragraphs above must be documented in the attendee's Workday

Learning training record using the self-reported learning choice.

- (1) Staff members are responsible for providing their supervisors with supporting documentation of the training or activity.
- (2) An activity is deemed professional development as determined by the supervisor.

- d) OYA staff may view their individual training records in Workday Learning.

H. Staff responsibilities during training sessions

1. Classroom training sessions, including virtual classrooms, are considered part of the regular workday. Training participants are expected to maintain professional standards and be prepared to fully engage in all aspects of the training.

Participants must:

- a) Bring required materials;
 - b) Wear clothing appropriate for a professional setting and the training activity;
 - c) Arrive on time for each session and return promptly from designated breaks; and
 - d) Follow the instructions of the qualified instructor or authorized presenters.
2. Qualified instructors will maintain an appropriate learning environment and may redirect any participant whose behavior is unsafe or disrupts the training.
 3. Any participant who fails to follow reasonable instructions from a qualified instructor may be considered disruptive and may be subject to appropriate corrective action, as determined by their supervisor.

V. LOCAL OPERATING PROTOCOL REQUIRED: NO